

Project Requirements Guide

ctrlaltcrew — What to Prepare Before Requesting an Estimate

This guide explains what information a client should prepare before requesting a project estimate. Providing this information up front (during the Requirement Gathering stage of the Project Development Process) leads to a faster, more accurate estimate.

1. Core Requirement Categories

The checklist below applies across most project types. Not every field applies to every project.

Business type

What kind of business or organization this is (e.g., retail, restaurant, healthcare-related, education, professional services, startup).

Project type

The category of work needed — website, mobile app, e-commerce store, backend/API, AI chatbot, RAG assistant, or automation.

Target users

Who will use the product: customers, internal staff, both, and roughly how many users are expected.

Required features

A list of must-have features, ideally in priority order, distinguishing 'must-have' from 'nice-to-have.'

Platform

Where the product needs to run: web browser, iOS, Android, or a combination.

Integrations

Any existing tools or services the product must connect to (payment gateways, CRMs, email/SMS providers, existing databases, internal APIs).

Budget

An approximate budget range, even a rough one, to help align the proposed scope with what is financially feasible.

Timeline

Any hard deadlines (e.g., an event, a funding milestone, a seasonal launch) versus a flexible timeline.

Design requirements

Whether a custom visual design is needed, whether existing brand assets (logo, colors, fonts) are available, and any reference products the client likes.

Existing systems

Details of any current website, app, or backend that the new work needs to replace, extend, or integrate with.

Authentication requirements

Whether the product needs user accounts/login, and if so, what types of users or roles exist (e.g., customer vs. admin).

Payment requirements

Whether the product needs to process payments, and if so, which currencies, payment methods, or regions are involved.

AI requirements (where relevant)

For AI/LLM projects: what source documents or data exist, what questions the AI should be able to answer, and whether the AI should only answer questions or also take actions.

2. Example Requirement Profiles by Business Type

The examples below illustrate how these fields are typically filled in for different kinds of businesses. They are illustrative starting points, not fixed requirements.

Restaurant

Field	Typical Answer
Project type	Business website with online ordering, or a mobile ordering app
Target users	Customers browsing the menu and placing orders; staff managing incoming orders
Key features	Menu display, online ordering and payment, order status tracking, table reservation (optional)
Platform	Web, with an optional mobile app for repeat customers
Common integrations	Payment gateway, SMS/WhatsApp notifications for order updates, point-of-sale system (if integration is required)

A restaurant project usually maps to the Business Web Application or E-Commerce Application package depending on whether direct online payment is required.

E-Commerce Business

Field	Typical Answer
Project type	Online store
Target users	Customers browsing and purchasing products; internal staff managing inventory and orders
Key features	Product catalog, cart and checkout, payment gateway, order management, customer accounts

Field	Typical Answer
Platform	Web, often with a companion mobile app added later
Common integrations	Payment gateway, shipping/logistics provider, email marketing tool, inventory system

This maps directly to the E-Commerce Application package; an AI chatbot for order-status questions is a common add-on.

Educational Business

Field	Typical Answer
Project type	Course/content platform or booking system for classes
Target users	Students or learners; instructors/administrators managing content or schedules
Key features	Course or class listings, enrollment/booking, content delivery (video or documents), progress tracking
Platform	Web, with mobile access via responsive design or a dedicated app
Common integrations	Payment gateway for course fees, video hosting service, calendar/scheduling tools

Depending on complexity, this maps to a Business Web Application; a RAG-based assistant can be added to answer student questions from course materials.

Healthcare-Related Business

Field	Typical Answer
Project type	Appointment booking system or administrative portal
Target users	Patients or clients booking appointments; administrative staff managing schedules
Key features	Appointment scheduling, reminders, basic patient/client record management, secure login
Platform	Web, with optional mobile access
Common integrations	Calendar systems, SMS/email reminder services

Healthcare-adjacent administrative tools map to the Business Web Application package. Any project touching regulated health data should flag applicable compliance requirements during requirement gathering so the scope can account for them; ctrlaltcrew does not claim certification against specific healthcare regulations and this should be discussed directly with the team for any project involving protected health information.

Service-Based Business

Field	Typical Answer
Project type	Business website with lead capture, or a booking/scheduling portal

Field	Typical Answer
Target users	Prospective clients requesting information or booking a service; staff managing leads
Key features	Service listings, contact/quote request forms, booking calendar, optional AI chatbot for lead qualification
Platform	Web
Common integrations	Calendar tools, CRM, email notifications

This typically maps to the Business Web Application package, often paired with an AI Chatbot package for lead qualification.

Startup (New Product)

Field	Typical Answer
Project type	MVP web or mobile application
Target users	Early adopters or a defined target market for the startup's product
Key features	Core feature set needed to validate the product idea, kept intentionally minimal at first
Platform	Depends on the product — web, mobile, or both
Common integrations	Varies by product; often includes authentication and a payment or subscription system

Startups are encouraged to prioritize a minimal but functional feature set for the first version, since a smaller, focused MVP maps to a lower cost and shorter timeline, with additional features added in later phases.

3. What Happens if Requirements Are Incomplete

It's common for clients to not have every detail ready at first contact. The AI Project Consultant and the ctrlaltcrew team can work with partial information to give a rough estimate range, and will ask targeted follow-up questions to fill in the gaps needed for a firm scope and price before development begins.